



Twitter testing Spaces on mobile

iOS users may get to experience a dedicated tab for Spaces.
<https://dgit.in/nov21-76>



\$70K fine for Facebook

Facebook was fined \$70K for flouting the GDPR order made by a UK watchdog.
<https://dgit.in/nov21-77>

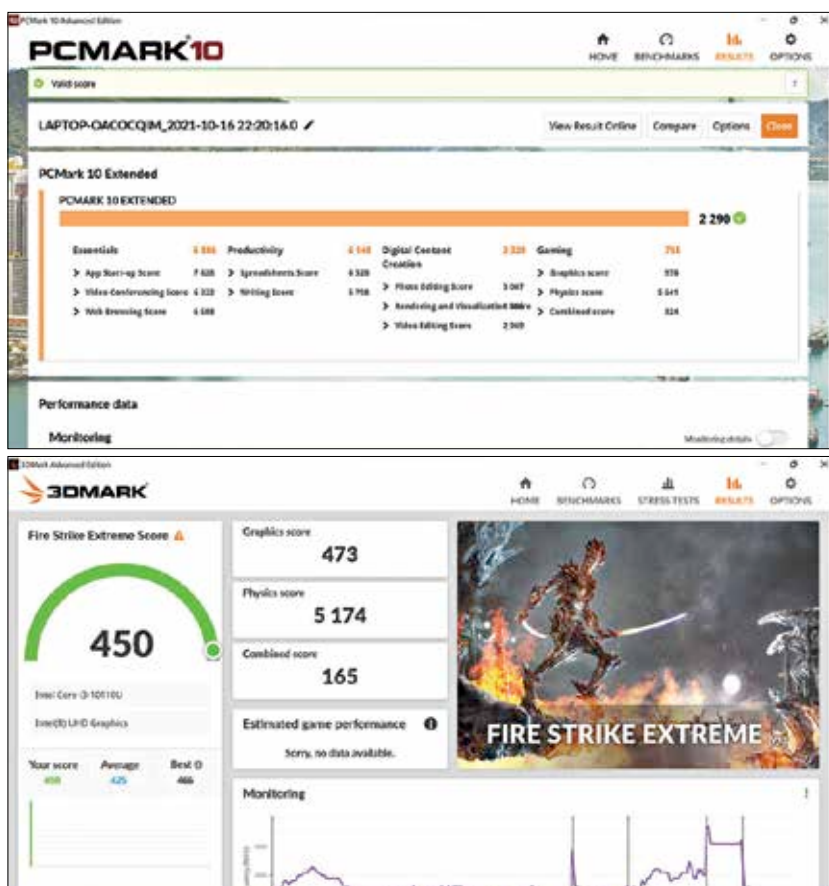
can be accessed by clicking the Widgets button on the Taskbar. Here you can add different widgets which show things like news headlines, weather, and your calendar. For now, we did not find ourselves too dependent on the Widgets functionality, but it could become central to our Windows 11 experience in the future.

Now, let's discuss the gaming-related features that Windows 11 brings. There are two main features that will be of the most interest to users. The first is Auto HDR, while the other is DirectStorage. The former functions uses machine learning to enhance lighting detail in visuals on screen, by replicating high dynamic range lighting in DirectX 11/12 games which do not offer support for it. This is an interesting feature and will come in handy for a lot of users who play older generation titles.

The second feature here is DirectStorage that promises to greatly enhance the gaming experience by cutting downloading times of games. This appears to be an extension of the attempts being made by Microsoft with the Xbox Series X/S consoles where it has used clever tricks to greatly improve load times of games. However, since Microsoft can only control the software on Windows-based machines, here it is using a system that now pipes game data directly to the graphics card, instead of running it through the CPU to make game loading faster. Do note that this feature will only be available on select games that support DirectStorage API on a PC with an NVMe SSD and a GPU that supports DirectX12 Ultimate.

PERFORMANCE

How does Windows 11 compare to Windows 10 in performance? We tested both Windows 11 and Windows 10 on the same hardware to see if the former offers improved performance in synthetic benchmarks. This was a Lenovo machine running an Intel Core i3 - 10110U CPU with 2 cores and 4 threads running at 2.6Ghz. For graphics, this laptop offered Intel's



onboard graphics. The first test we ran was Cinebench R20 which gave threw up a score of 734 points. Interestingly, this was slightly lower than the score of the laptop on the same benchmark on Windows 10. The same was the case for 3D Mark Fire Strike Extreme which scored 450 points on Windows 11. In comparison, on Windows 10, the same benchmark threw a score of 468.

Again, for PC Mark WildLife, this was exactly the case, as the same hardware running Windows 11 managed to clock a lower score of 2290 points as compared to when we tested it using Windows 10. In all cases, we realised Windows 11 running the same hardware was giving around 2-3 per cent lower performance than Windows 10 on the same machine. So, Windows 11 is still not working to its full potential.

For now, we can't pinpoint exactly why this is happening, but our best guess is that Windows 11 is still a little rough around the corners, and possibly needs a couple of updates to help it start

functioning to its full potential. After which, we should see similar if not better performance on Windows 11 as compared to Windows 10.

VERDICT

So, should you upgrade to Windows 11? Well, eventually yes.

The operating system offers a ton of new features and visual upgrades that make it a better, and fresher offering than Windows 10. However, as we found out when running benchmarks on Windows 11, the new operating system, for now, is not without its issues.

There appear to be bugs in the code that are holding back the performance of Windows 11, even if it's by a measly 2-3 per cent. While that may not be too big a deal for some, in our opinion, it is enough to make us wait for a few weeks at least before moving to Windows 11 as Microsoft should be able to iron out these minor issues with software updates soon enough. **d**